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# Hackles Day in a Box

## *The Hackles Kit*

A free kit by Competence Collective · [competencecollective.org](https://competencecollective.org) · [quillsup.org](https://quillsup.org) · October 2026

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A budget sheet and a short outline for running Hackles Day, the school event in the kit. The full plan is in `kit/07_Assessment/Hackles_Day_Kit.md`, with an add-on in `kit/14_Games_and_Fun/09_Hackles_Day_Event_Plan.md`. This page adds the money and the logistics that an administrator asks about. The workbook is `Hackles_Day_Budget.xlsx`.

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## What Hackles Day is

A **SCHOOL OR LIBRARY** event where students move through short stations that practice Hackles up, Pause, Check, Tell and the Help Ladder, followed by an optional family night. It is not a presentation by outsiders about scary stories. Station leaders are staff, trained volunteers, and older students. Volunteers never work alone with students, follow your visitor and background-check policy, and are not agents of the publisher. [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM] The kit says to keep sponsor branding out and never to collect student information.

## Formats (pick one)

| FORMAT                     | TIME                       | NEEDS                                          | BEST FOR        |
|----------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Classroom mini Hackles Day | 45 minutes                 | One teacher, no volunteers                     | Smallest budget |
| Single-band event          | 90 minutes                 | Stations for one band, staff only              | One grade band  |
| Half-day rotation          | 3 to 4 hours               | Stations by band, volunteers, counselor corner | Whole school    |
| Family night               | 60 to 75 minutes (evening) | Presenter, counselor, handouts                 | Families        |

## What goes in the box

| ITEM                                             | SOURCE IN THE KIT                                            | NOTES                                                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Station cards and activity sheets by band        | Hackles Day Kit, section 4                                   | Station counts vary by band and school; the budget sheet uses 8 as a placeholder |
| Puzzle hunts with answer keys                    | Hackles Day Kit, section 5                                   | Print the answer keys only for station leaders                                   |
| Passport (one per student)                       | Hackles Day Kit, section 12                                  | Folded paper with a stamp space per station and a My Trusted Adults page         |
| Certificates                                     | Hackles Day Kit, section 9                                   |                                                                                  |
| Volunteer rules and training agenda              | Hackles Day Kit, section 7                                   | 60-minute training                                                               |
| Family night agenda and script                   | Hackles Day Kit, section 8; Parent Night Presentation Script |                                                                                  |
| Counselor Corner, Tell Someone Wall, quiet space | Hackles Day Kit, signage section                             |                                                                                  |
| Counselor coordination                           | Counselor Coordination Protocol (this pack)                  | Sensitive activities need heads-up and notice                                    |
| First 10 Minutes card                            | Crisis and Disclosure Flowchart                              | One for every station leader and volunteer                                       |
| Photo and media rules                            | Hackles Day Kit, safety section                              | Default: no photos of students in promotion                                      |

## The budget sheet

**THE WORKBOOK HAS TWO** sheets. On **Inputs** you type the number of students, family members, volunteers, stations, interpreter hours and childcare hours. On **Budget** each line multiplies a quantity by a unit cost. Two unit-cost columns, standard and low-cost, give you a range. A column for donated or in-kind value shows the net cost. A bar chart compares the two scenarios. Contingency defaults to 10%.

**The unit costs in the workbook are placeholders.** They are rough starting numbers, not quotes and not facts about your area. Replace each with a quote from your vendor or your copy center before you present the budget. [VERIFY]

**EXAMPLE RUN (300 STUDENTS, 150 FAMILY MEMBERS, 12 VOLUNTEERS, 8 STATIONS)**

| SCENARIO                   | SUBTOTAL   | WITH 10% CONTINGENCY | PER STUDENT |
|----------------------------|------------|----------------------|-------------|
| Standard placeholder costs | \$1,350.00 | \$1,485.00           | \$4.95      |
| Low-cost placeholder costs | \$186.00   | \$204.60             | \$0.68      |

The low-cost column assumes classroom supplies, school-owned lanyards, bilingual staff in place of paid interpreters, volunteer childcare under your supervision policy, and no food. It is a planning scenario, not a recommendation to skip interpreters where families need them.

**BUDGET LINES**

| LINE                                        | BASIS                | WHAT TO CHECK                                                                 |
|---------------------------------------------|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Printing: student passports                 | 4 pages per student  | Use your copy center price                                                    |
| Printing: family handouts                   | 6 pages per family   |                                                                               |
| Printing: station cards, signs, hunt sheets | 25 pages per station |                                                                               |
| Certificates                                | 1 per student        | Cardstock or plain paper                                                      |
| Craft and station supplies                  | per 100 students     | Classroom stock first                                                         |
| Stamps, stickers, ribbons                   | per student          | No sponsor branding; no sign-up rewards                                       |
| Volunteer badges and lanyards               | per volunteer        | Reuse                                                                         |
| Food and drink                              | per family           | Optional; check allergy and food policies                                     |
| Translation and interpreters                | hours                | Qualified interpreters; do not rely on machine translation for safety wording |
| Childcare during family night               | staff-hours          | Only if offered; follow supervision policy                                    |
| Posters and signage                         | lump sum             |                                                                               |
| First aid, tissues, sanitizer               | lump sum             |                                                                               |
| Thank-you items                             | per volunteer        | Check your gift policy                                                        |

## Funding and sponsors

- Pay from an existing operating or PTA line if possible.
- Do not accept sponsorship that puts a brand on lessons, advertises to children, or collects student data. [VERIFY district sponsorship policy]
- If a local business offers to donate, accept goods that carry no promotion to students, such as paper or snacks, and thank them privately.
- Competence Collective has not agreed to fund events or send staff. [CONTACT: to be added]

## Timeline (8 weeks)

| WHEN                | TASK                                                                                                         |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 8 to 6 weeks before | Pick the date and format. Set the budget. Book space, volunteers and the counselor                           |
| 5 to 3 weeks before | Complete volunteer vetting per your policy. Print passports and station cards. Recruit older-student helpers |
| 2 weeks before      | Family letters. Sensitive stations flagged with pre-notice and alternates                                    |
| 1 week before       | Volunteer training (60 minutes). Final counts. Dry run                                                       |
| Day before          | Set up stations and signs. Confirm counselor coverage                                                        |
| Event day           | Check-in. First 10 Minutes cards out. Counselor Corner open                                                  |
| After               | Thank-yous. Counts to the tracker. Debrief                                                                   |

## Safety rules at the event

1. Counselor or backup on site the whole time.
2. Volunteers never alone with a student, never take photos of students on personal devices, and hand out nothing from a company.
3. Station leaders carry the First 10 Minutes card and know the local reporting route.
4. Any station that covers a sensitive topic is not run as a public performance, and nobody is asked to share personal experiences.
5. Plan for accessibility: wheelchair routes, sensory-friendly space, large print, interpreters, quiet room.
6. Count attendance by number. Do not collect names for the tracker.

## After the event

**ADD COUNTS TO THE** tracker's Family sheet (attendees) and note any follow-up in your confidential files. Share a short thank-you with families. Use the evidence-limits wording if you report any survey results.